

MERIDIAN INDUSTRIAL SUPPLY GMBH

Client background — shared with BOREK (confidential, fictional demo data)

Version: 2026-09-01 · Contact: Sandra Krüger, Head of Accounts Payable

1. COMPANY SNAPSHOT

Legal name: Meridian Industrial Supply GmbH

HQ: Hannover, Germany (operations also in Bremen warehouse)

Industry: B2B distribution of industrial fasteners, tools, and MRO

Employees: ~420 FTE (180 in Finance & Operations shared services)

ERP: SAP S/4HANA (cloud), instance EU-West

IT landscape: Microsoft 365 (Exchange Online shared mailboxes), ServiceNow for internal IT requests

Meridian sells to manufacturing customers across DACH. Growth over the last three years increased supplier invoice volume

2. CURRENT AP PROCESS (AS-IS)

- Incoming supplier invoices arrive as PDF in ap-invoices@meridian-industrial.example (shared mailbox).
- Clerks download attachments, run OCR (ABBYY on desktop), correct line items manually.
- Matching in SAP: purchase order (PO), goods receipt (GR), invoice — classic 3-way match.
- Clean match: ~2–3 minutes per invoice. Exception: 15–20 minutes plus waiting on buyers.
- Volume: ~3,100 supplier invoices/month (excluding intercompany).
- Exception rate: ~26% require clarification (price variance, partial delivery, missing PO, duplicates).
- Credit notes (~5% of volume) handled manually; not in scope for initial automation.

3. PAIN POINTS & TARGETS

Pain:

- Month-end close target is 5 business days (CFO priority); AP is a bottleneck.
- Buyers are interrupted daily for match clarifications.
- Duplicate postings occurred twice in 2025 (caught post-payment; remediation costly).

Targets for pilot (invoice matching only):

- Auto-match rate: from ~0% assisted today to ≥85% on “clean” rule set.
- Manual effort on automatable core: from ~75 h/month to ≤12 h/month.
- Zero wrong postings outside agreed tolerances.
- 100% duplicate detection before posting.
- Cycle time for clean cases: under 30 minutes mailbox-to-posting.

Loaded cost assumption for business case: EUR 45/hour (fully loaded clerk).

4. MATCHING RULES (BUSINESS SUMMARY)

- Quantity: exact match PO line vs GR vs invoice line.
- Unit price: exact unless active discount agreement in SAP.
- Total amount: rounding tolerance up to EUR 0.50.
- If deviation vs PO >2% → always hold for human review.
- Invoice number already posted → block duplicate; never auto-post.
- Invoices > EUR 5,000 → one-click human approval even if rules pass.

Out of scope for phase 1: credit notes, warehouse labelling, supplier self-service portal.

5. TECHNICAL & COMPLIANCE CONSTRAINTS

- Data classification: Confidential (supplier bank details on invoices).
- Processing and storage: EU only.
- Raw PDFs: not retained after extraction (metadata + structured fields only).
- IBAN: masked outside ERP; posting only via approved technical user.

- ERP write access for payment proposals: requires sign-off from IT Lead (Thomas Berg).
- Sandbox available; Sandra can provide 30–50 historical invoices (bank details redacted).
- Agent must NOT email suppliers autonomously in phase 1.
- Full audit log; kill switch required.

6. STAKEHOLDERS

Sandra Krüger Head of AP (sponsor, process owner)

Dr. Eva Lindemann CFO (economic buyer)

7. TIMELINE & BUDGET (INDICATIVE)

- Decision on pilot vendor: Q4 2026.
- Pilot go-live (one company code, DE01): Q1 2027.
- Budget envelope discussed internally: EUR 120–180k for pilot build + 3 months hypercare (not approved yet).

8. WHY BOREK

Meridian was referred by an existing BOREK customer in logistics automation. Sandra requested a structured discovery wor